DSPA's Data Science Major Essentials

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Instructions

This document is made to centralize all essential information and resources for *declared* Data Science majors in the College of Computing, Data Science, and Society at UC Berkeley. Please keep in mind this is **NOT** an exhaustive list of information, but the resources below are the most commonly referenced and used ones.

Please feel free to reach out to the Data Science Peer Advising team by booking a drop-in appointment at
130 Warren Hall (we would love to meet you!) if you have questions about anything on this document or if you would just like to chat!

Also, follow us on Instagram @berkeley_dspa! It's a great way to connect with us and stay up-to-date with tips and resources throughout the school year!

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Advising

DS Peer Advisors

Advising

- We're your one stop shop for new data science friends, getting advice, choosing classes, planning out your major(s), and questions about the new College of Computing, Data Science, and Society! We'd love to see you come by **130 Warren Hall** to our drop-in hours!
    - For any questions, no matter how big or small, feel free to book an appointment with any of us!
- How do I get to 130 Warren Hall? Google Maps link
- Follow us on Instagram: @berkeley_dspa

- Link: data.berkeley.edu/degrees/peer-advising

DS Advisors (Staff)

Advising

- DS Advisors are Data Science Undergraduate Studies DSUS **staff** who are available to help out with any issues related to the DS major.
- To get the most up-to-date and accurate information, it's recommended to meet with a staff advisor, especially if it concerns graduating on time, declaring on time, or anything else with an urgent deadline.
- Online appointments can be booked to answer any questions and concerns
- Link: data.berkeley.edu/data-science-advising

Join Data 001 Ed

General Information

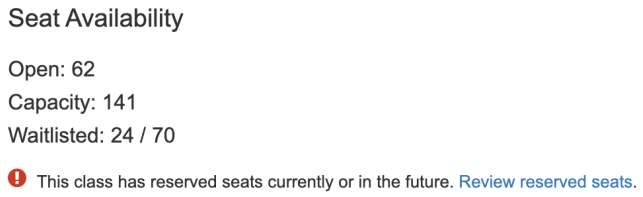
- Forum for data science students (major/minor/intended) to ask questions about classes, professors, grades, etc.
- Good alternative to ask questions to DS staff and students (instead via Email or Reddit)
- Link: edstem.org/us/join/gk5MZQ

Course Selection & Enrollment

Enrolling in Data Science (DATA) Classes

Course Selection & Enrollment

- Data science (DATA) courses have a variety of classes with a mix of unreserved seats and reserved seats. Lower division courses tend to have unreserved seats while most upper division courses have reserved seats.
- Even for declared Data Science majors, some seats may be reserved for specific students, like how DATA C102 has reserved seats for Data Science majors with 7 or more semesters in attendance
    - Please **check** whether or not you qualify for reserved seats if you are not able to enroll in a course before contacting DS major advisors
- To see more details on how many seats are reserved for certain students, click on the course in the Enrollment Center on CalCentral. Then, scroll down to see the "Seat Availability" section. If you click on the words "Review reserved seats", you will be able to see more details about reserved seats via the class page on classes.berkeley.edu.



Check DS Major Requirements

Course Selection & Enrollment

- The data science major is composed of Lower-Division requirements, Upper Division requirements, and a Domain Emphasis.
    - Click on a link to see more for information.
- Click here to see the rules on overlapping classes
    - For any specific questions about this, please come by DSPA office hours at 130 Warren Hall! Sign up here.
- Link: data.berkeley.edu/academics/data-science-major

Tools for Course Selection

Course Selection & Enrollment

- **Academic Guide - Data Science**
    - Complete list of all DS courses (past and present)
        - Some courses may not be offered, which can be confirmed by clicking on the title of a class and seeing the semesters when it was last taught (Fall 2023, Spring 2011, etc.)
    - Good way to see all of the options available in one place, especially if you're planning for future semesters
- **BerkeleyTime**
    - Used for finding courses, seeing grade distributions on courses, and schedule planning
        - Especially useful for finding breadth courses and electives
        - PRO TIP: Sort by grade when using the "Catalog"
    - **Caution**: BerkeleyTime may not accurately reflect satisfying requirements, always check with a DS Advisor
- **CalCentral Schedule Planner** ← Link will only work if you are logged into CalCentral
    - Used for visualizing potential course schedules and making sure no classes overlap
    - This tool is extremely useful for seeing the different schedules you would be able to have depending on which discussion/lab sections you choose.
        - Gives all possible combinations of lecture/discussion/lab times
    - Tutorial Video Link: youtube.com/watch?v=oKdg4zEO3Ko

Extracurriculars

Student Clubs & Organizations (Data-related)

Extracurriculars

- CalLink is a resource for finding all student organizations, including clubs, fraternities, etc.
- Here is a list of a few Data Science student organizations. This is NOT an exhaustive list and is in NO particular order, please check the link below to explore more organizations. Most organizations have applications that open every Fall and Spring semester.
  Click on an organization to go to their website.
    - Data Science Society at Berkeley

    - Big Data at Berkeley
    - SAAS
    - DataStory
    - DataGood
    - Women in Computing and Data Science at Berkeley
    - Sports Analytics Group at Berkeley
    - Machine Learning at Berkeley
- Link: callink.berkeley.edu/organizations?query=data
  NOTE: The link above filters for organizations related to "data". To see all clubs/organizations, remove this filter.

Data Science Discovery Program

Extracurriculars

- The Data Science Discovery Program (which will be referred to as "DS Discovery") is a way for UC Berkeley students interested in data science to be partnered with academic institutions, government agencies, non-profit, and industry partners in data-focused projects.
- DS Discovery is a **great** way to get experience in real-life applications of data science
    - Some projects are research focused, while others are internships within companies.
    - Certain projects may be more popular than others, and thus may be more competitive to get into. With this in mind, please make sure to look at the recommended skills that are listed in the project description for each one.
- DS Discovery is NOT a paid opportunity, participants are compensated with academic units by enrolling in one of the "DATA 198" courses. This happens a few weeks AFTER you are accepted into a project.
- For Fall 2023, you were allowed to apply to **10** (or fewer) projects. This information is likely to change by semester. Check Ed Discussion for updates.
- Many DS Peer Advisors have participated in DS Discovery projects, so please come to DSPA drop-in hours at 130 Warren Hall to hear about our experiences! Learn more here.
- Link: data.berkeley.edu/discovery

Data Science Research

Extracurriculars

- CDSS's research institutes, labs, and centers offer many research opportunities, from fundamental research to advanced applications in Berkeley's robust data science and computing environment.
- Many of these opportunities are open to people from all majors, but are suited more for those with a technical background (CS/EECS, DS, Statistics, Mathematics, etc.)
    - Like DS Discovery, some opportunities may have more requirements and competition than others, so getting in is not guaranteed. However, don't be afraid to apply!
- Link: data.berkeley.edu/research

Other CDSS Student Opportunities

Extracurriculars

- Looking for research programs, internships, workshops, and other student focused opportunities?
  Check out any of the programs available at CDSS
- These are more great options for getting hands-on experience in data science, especially if you are interested in combining data science in other fields (Biology, Healthcare, etc.)
- Link: data.berkeley.edu/academics#academicenrichment

Mentorship

Data Scholars

Mentorship

- The Data Scholars Program provides spaces where students from many disciplines and backgrounds learn together, develop their data science skills, and co-create a diverse community.
- Students receive mentorship, support in introductory data science classes, and guidance to advance in the field through academic support, research opportunities, professional development, and community with other Scholars.
- Data Scholars receive support in Data 8 through weekly workshops, dedicated office hours, and advising
- Link: data.berkeley.edu/data-science/data-scholars

Other

Changing Domain Emphasis

Other

- Changing your domain emphasis (after you're declared) is a very simple process: Submit a new online major declaration request and select the **"Change Domain Emphasis"** option.
  - You will need to attach documents showing the courses you plan to use toward your new Domain Emphasis.
- The "major declaration request" form opens every semester (Spring, Summer, Fall), and can be found at this link.
- There is NO deadline for changing your Domain Emphasis, but make sure to submit any request several weeks before the end of your final term to ensure it is processed on time.
- For any questions about Domain Emphasis courses or changing Domain Emphases, come by to DSPA drop-in hours at 130 Warren Hall! Learn more here.
- Link: Change DS Domain Emphasis

Study Abroad for Data Science Majors

Other

- Study Abroad For Data Science Major Website:
  https://data.berkeley.edu/study-abroad-data-science-majors

    - Who can study abroad? Anyone as a Data Science Major!
    - When should I go abroad? Most students study abroad during their junior year, but it all depends on your schedule and what works best for you.
- What classes can I take abroad?
    - There are no restrictions on what course you can or can not take abroad, but regardless all courses need to be petitioned and reviewed by a Data Science advisor.
- Pre-Approved Breadth Database: https://b4.caspio.com/dp/18a72000d2575f5f54c743c3ad8c
- List of Previous Petitions:
    - https://c0eru180.caspio.com/dp/18a7200027bc51c5ef1b40e19be5
- Introduction to Study Abroad Presentation
- Study Abroad Peer Advisors Website: https://myapp.berkeley.edu/portal/bsa-peers?tab=meet
- Berkeley Study Abroad Website: https://studyabroad.berkeley.edu/explore

Adding Additional Major/Minor

Other

- To learn more about adding a double major, simultaneous degree, or minor, please come by DSPA or DS Advising (Staff) drop-in hours.
    - NOTE: Data Science Majors **cannot** also have a Data Science minor.
- Please book an appointment with the DSPAs or a DS staff advisor.